

Chapter

Act from Happiness — One Key to a Successful Life



Introduction: One Task, Two Outlooks

All our lives we keep doing something — a job, a business, running a household, even marriage. But according to Acharya Upendra ji, the real question is not **what** we do, but **in what spirit** we do it. He points to a simple distinction that can change the direction of an entire life:

"There are two ways of doing work — doing it in order to become happy, and doing it out of happiness."

1. The First Way: Working in Order to Become Happy

Most people live the first way. Acharya ji explains it in our everyday language:

"What does doing it to become happy mean? I want a salary, I want a promotion, so I am doing it. In return for this I am going to get that, so I am doing this."

This spirit of a deal does not stay limited to the job — it seeps into relationships too:

"I am even getting married so that I get so and so some joy — that is why I am doing it. So that my household runs, her salary will also get added. I am a doctor, she is a doctor — we get married and our hospital will run."

Where the calculation of "what will I get in return" begins, work turns into a transaction.

2. Expectation and Self-Interest: The Seed of Sorrow

Acharya ji clearly identifies the problem hidden in this first way:

"Now expectation has come into it. So what will happen in this? There is no unconditional love. What did I see in it? My own benefit — self-interest has come in."

And he states the result without any softening:

"Now I am doing this in order to become happy, so I cannot be happy in it. After certain time, only sorrow is going to come."

A happiness that rests on some outer reward comes and goes with that reward. **Work done from expectation ultimately brings only sorrow.**

3. The Second Way: Working Out of Happiness

Now Acharya ji shows the second path — where joy is not the result of the work, but its starting point:

"What is the second way? It is to do it out of happiness. Meaning, if I have to do business, it is not to get money. I know how to make one thing, or I know how to offer one service — that itself is my passion."

"I should feel joy in it anyway, without money also. Now I am simply sharing it with others."

He makes it clearer with the example of a painter:

"I am a painter; I am good at painting anyway. So if I give my paintings to others as well, I will also get money for it. So I am not doing it in order to become happy — I am doing it out of happiness."

"The joy was already there, without anyone giving reward or anything. So that is the profession you should take up."

The work that gives you joy even without any reward — that is your true calling. Money still comes, but as a natural result, not as the goal.

4. The Vision of the Bhagavad Gita: From Passion to Karma Yoga

Acharya ji then lifts this principle to a spiritual height:

"This is mentioned in the Bhagavad Gita — that one who does only the work of their passion — do what you like and like what you do — can move towards moksha; he qualifies for Karma Yoga."

Karma Yoga means making action itself a yoga — acting without attachment to its fruits, so that the same action becomes a means of liberation (**moksha**) instead of bondage. According to Acharya ji, its sign is simple:

"Do work that feels like play. Work should not feel like work, it should feel like play — like that. It should feel like happiness; there should be joy in it."

When work starts to feel like play, it becomes Karma Yoga — and Karma Yoga leads towards liberation.

5. At the Root Is Unconditional Love

Where does this joy come from? Acharya ji names its source — **unconditional love**:

"So it cannot happen at all without unconditional love — unconditional love for the one you are giving to, and for yourself as well."

"While you are doing it, you yourself should also enjoy it."

This love flows in both directions — towards those we are doing it for, and towards ourselves. **True love for others cannot flow into a work that we ourselves do not enjoy.**

6. An Example from the Home: The Woman Who Cooks

Acharya ji explains this principle through a simple example from household life:

"So the woman who enjoys cooking — she enjoys it anyway — will cook well at her in-laws' home, and will cook well here too."

"Initially she should be happy. It is to be done out of happiness, not in order to become happy — not with the thought 'if I do this I will get this, if I do that I will get that.' It is by default — that is simply the work they do."

One whose joy comes from within does not change their work when circumstances change — whether at her parents' home or her in-laws', she does it with the same love. **The joy within decides the quality of the work outside.**

7. Acharya Ji's Own Example

Finally, Acharya ji points to his own life — he lives what he teaches:

"I love to teach, but I also love to learn. So I keep learning new things, and I keep giving you what I have learned. So it's better that I do that."

Learning and teaching — both are joy for him, not means to some reward. This is the living form of "acting out of happiness."

Summary: Key Teachings

- 1** There are two ways to work — doing it in order to become happy, and doing it out of happiness.
- 2** Work done in order to become happy — for salary, promotion or gain — is full of expectation and self-interest, and after some time brings only sorrow.
- 3** Work done out of happiness is the work that gives joy even without money or reward — that is your passion and your true profession.

- 4 **Do what you like and like what you do** — when work starts to feel like play, it becomes Karma Yoga and leads towards liberation.
- 5 **Its root is unconditional love** — for those you are doing it for, and for yourself as well.
- 6 **Let the inner joy come first, and the action after** — then, whatever the circumstances, the work is done with the same love and quality.